

Lab 1: Block Specific IPs with AWS WAF + Test Using `curl`

Goal:

Block traffic from a specific IP using a Web ACL attached to **CloudFront** or **ALB**, and verify using `curl`.

Steps:

1. Create Web ACL:

- Go to **AWS WAF > Web ACLs > Create**
- Name: `ip-block-waf`
- Region: `Global` (for CloudFront) or choose ALB region
- Resource type: CloudFront or Application Load Balancer
- Associate the ACL to your resource

2. Create IP Set:

- Go to **IP Sets > Create**
- Name: `blocked-ip-set`
- Add your **public IP address** or simulated IP to block (`x.x.x.x/32`)

3. Create Rule:

- Rule name: `BlockBadIP`
- Rule type: IP match

- Use `blocked-ip-set`
- Action: **Block**
- Priority: 1

Test with curl:

`curl -I https://your-distribution-or-alb-endpoint`

- 4.
5. **Expected:** `403 Forbidden` response.

Lab 2: Use AWS Managed Rule Set to Block Common Attacks

Goal:

Apply **AWSManagedRulesCommonRuleSet** to protect your app from OWASP Top 10 threats.

Steps:

1. Go to your Web ACL > Add rules > **Add managed rule groups**
2. Select:
 - Vendor: `AWS`
 - Rule group: `AWSManagedRulesCommonRuleSet`
3. Set action to `Count` initially (optional)
4. Save and deploy.

Test:

Use tools like:

```
curl -H "User-Agent: BadBot" https://your-app-url
```



Check logs/CloudWatch metrics for detection.



Lab 3: Attach AWS WAF to API Gateway & Inspect Logs



Goal:

Protect your API from unwanted requests and monitor logs.



Steps:

1. Create a **REST API** using Amazon API Gateway.
2. Deploy it (example: `/hello` endpoint).
3. Create a **Web ACL** and attach it to the API Gateway.
4. Add a simple rule:
 - Block requests from specific IP or path
5. Enable logging:
 - Go to Web ACL > **Logging and metrics**
 - Enable logging to **S3** or **CloudWatch Logs**

Access the endpoint:

```
curl https://api-id.execute-api.region.amazonaws.com/stage/hello
```

- 6.
 7. Observe log records in CloudWatch or S3.
-

Lab 4: Simulate SQL Injection and Observe WAF Response

Goal:

Use `curl` to simulate SQLi and let AWS WAF block it using managed rules.

Steps:

1. Add **AWSManagedRulesSQLiRuleSet** to your Web ACL
2. Action: **Block**

Deploy and test with:

```
curl "https://your-app.com/login?user=admin'--"
```

- 3.
4. Observe:
 - `403 Forbidden` response
 - Log entry indicating SQLi rule triggered

Lab 5: Enable WAF Logging to Amazon S3 & Analyze

Goal:

Enable full request/response logging to an S3 bucket.

Steps:

1. Go to Web ACL > **Logging and metrics**
2. Choose **Enable logging**
3. Select or create an S3 bucket (e.g., `waf-log-bucket`)

4. Save

Analyze:

- Use Athena or CloudWatch Insights to query logs
- Log entries look like:

```
{  
  "action": "BLOCK",  
  "ruleGroupList": [...],  
  "httpRequest": {  
    "clientIp": "x.x.x.x",  
    "uri": "/login",  
    "headers": [...]  
  }  
}
```

Deliverables for Students

-  Screenshot of Web ACLs and rules
 -  Test output ([curl](#) or browser) showing blocked access
 -  CloudWatch/S3 log entries with evidence of rules triggering
 -  Short reflection: What was blocked, why, and how WAF helped?
-

Bonus: Common curl Commands for Testing WAF

Normal request (should pass)

```
curl -I https://your-app
```

SQL Injection test

```
curl "https://your-app.com/search?q=test' OR 1=1--"
```

Cross-site scripting

```
curl "https://your-app.com/page?input=<script>alert(1)</script>"
```

```
# Bad User-Agent
```

```
curl -H "User-Agent: BadBot" https://your-app
```

```
# Send custom header
```

```
curl -H "X-Custom-Test: attack" https://your-app
```
